

THE BUILD: COPY GUIDE

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Every word you need for a new website.

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First edition, 2026.

Format: Digital template pack (Google Docs + PDF) **Price:** \$45 **Audience:** Founders and business owners launching or relaunching a website who need to write the copy themselves — or brief a copywriter — without guessing.



WHAT THIS IS

Building a website is not primarily a design problem. It's a copy problem. Most sites fail at the sentence level — the headline says nothing, the about page talks only about the company, the services page lists features with no outcomes. A beautiful site with weak copy is a beautiful building with no address.

This is the copy guide for The Build — my full-site strategy and production service — written so it stands alone. Every section, every page, every sentence you'll need: frameworks, fill-in templates, worked examples, swipe copy, and the one test that separates copy that converts from copy that just sounds nice.

Work top to bottom. Fill in the brief first; it makes every page downstream easier. Then write each page from its template, and run the whole thing through the test in Section Six before you ship.

Nobody reads your website. They scan it for evidence they're in the right place. Write for the scan, earn the read.



SECTION ONE: BEFORE YOU WRITE ANYTHING

The Positioning Brief

Five questions. Every word on the site comes from the answers. Write them down before you touch a single page.

1. **Who is this for?** One specific person, not a category.
2. **What's the one thing you do better or differently than anyone else?**
3. **What does the reader most need to believe to hire you?**
4. **What's the single most common objection — and the honest answer to it?**
5. **What do you want them to do right now?**

Worked example (a boutique financial-modeling firm):
For: a non-financial seed-stage founder prepping to raise. Better/different: we build the model AND teach you to defend it in the room. Need to believe: this won't be generic spreadsheet theater. Top objection: "I can find a cheaper

template" → answer: a template can't answer an investor's follow-up; we build for the questions, not the cells. Action: book a 20-minute fit call.

The Voice Snapshot

Three adjectives, three banned words, one "sounds like us" sentence. This is what keeps the site from reading like a committee wrote it.

Fill-in: We sound _____, _____, _____. We never say _____, _____, _____. At our best we write lines like:
" _____"



SECTION TWO: THE HOMEPAGE

One job: convince the right person they're in the right place, and point them to one next step.

The Hero

- **H1 formula:** *[What you do] for [who]* — with a verb, not a noun.  "We build financial models for early-stage founders."  "Financial Strategy Solutions." (A noun-pile says nothing; a verb makes a promise.)
- **Subhead formula:** the specific outcome your best clients get, in one sentence. *"Walk into your raise able to defend every number — not just present it."*
- **CTA:** use a verb that names the next step. **"Book a fit call" / "See the work" / "Get the model."** Never "Learn More" — it commits the reader to nothing and converts nothing.

The Social Proof Strip

Three kinds of proof, in order of power: **specific outcomes** ("closed a \$3M seed six weeks after we built the model"), **named quotes** (with company + title), **recognizable logos**. One line of real outcome beats five vague testimonials.

The Services Preview — the three-card rule

No more than three cards on the homepage. Each card: a one-line title, a one-line *outcome*, one CTA. *Example card — "The Raise Model · An investor-ready model you can defend in the room · See how it works →"*

The About Preview

One paragraph, written about what you *believe* — not who you are. It's a conviction statement, not a bio. *Example: "We think most founders lose the room not on the idea but on the math they can't defend. So we build the math with you, until the answer to every follow-up is already in your head."*

The Final CTA

Restate the offer simply, then add the friction-reducer that answers the last hesitation before the click. *Example: "Book a 20-minute fit call. If we're not the right fit, we'll tell you on the call and point you somewhere better."*



SECTION THREE: THE SERVICES PAGES

A services page fails one of two ways: features with no outcomes, or outcomes so vague it forgets to say what you actually get. Use this frame per service:

- **Header:** service name + one-line outcome.
- **The problem:** 3–4 sentences describing *their* situation, in their words, not your pitch.
- **The solution:** what you do and what it produces, concretely. *"You get X, Y, and Z. Within [timeframe] you'll have [deliverable]."*
- **The process (optional):** 3–5 steps. Makes the abstract feel real and de-risks the buy.
- **The proof:** one case or quote specific to *this* service.
- **The CTA:** price anchor ("from \$X") + booking link.

Worked mini-example — "The Raise Model": *Problem: "You're weeks from a raise with a spreadsheet you didn't build and can't fully defend. The model looks fine until an investor asks why churn flattens in month 14." Solution: "We rebuild your model with you — assumptions you can explain,*

scenarios you can run live, and a one-page summary that answers the five questions investors always ask. In two weeks you'll have a model and the fluency to defend it."
Proof: [client quote]. CTA: "From \$6,000 · Book a fit call →"

The pack includes adaptable templates for six page types: **retainer, project, digital product, course, coaching, done-for-you.**



SECTION FOUR: THE ABOUT PAGE

The most miswritten page on the internet. Most About pages are about the company; the best are about the reader, told through how you came to care. Six parts:

1. **The empathy opener** — start with *them*. Name the situation they're in.
2. **The bridge** — how you came to understand that situation. The true version.
3. **The conviction** — what you believe that shapes the work. A point of view, not a values list.
4. **The credentials** — brief, specific, ordered by relevance, not prestige.
5. **The human detail** — one non-professional thing. People buy from people.
6. **The CTA** — one next step.

Annotated opener example: *"Most founders don't lose the raise on the idea. They lose it on a number they can't defend at 4pm in a cold conference room. [empathy] I learned that the hard way, sitting in those rooms as the*

*analyst who watched great companies fumble the math.
[bridge] So I stopped building models for founders and
started building them with founders — because the model
isn't the deliverable; the confidence is. [conviction]"*



SECTION FIVE: THE CONTACT & BOOKING PAGES

The last page before they decide — and the one most likely to abandon them at the worst moment.

- **The micro-headline:** one line that justifies the friction of the form. *"Tell us where you are in your raise — we'll reply within one business day."*
- **The expectation-setter:** say exactly what happens next, with a timeline. *"You'll get a real reply from MK (not a bot) within 24 hours, with two times to talk."*
- **Form fields:** include only what you'll act on. Every extra field lowers completion. Name, email, one open question usually beats a ten-field interrogation.
- **The booking page:** warm the conversation above the embed. *"This is a 20-minute fit call. Come with one question about your raise; leave knowing whether we can help."*



SECTION SIX: THE ONE TEST

Run every sentence on the site through one question:

Does this sentence help the right person take the right action — or does it just make us feel good?

✗ Feels good: "We are a leading provider of integrated strategic financial solutions." ✓ Helps them: "We build the investor model you can actually defend in the room."

It's not an elegant test. It's just useful. Run all of it through before you publish — the homepage hero first, the About second, because those are where the feel-good sentences hide.



THE TEMPLATES (AND HOW TO USE THEM)

Each is a Google Doc you copy to your Drive — and every frame above is ready to rebuild anywhere: the **Positioning Brief**, the **Voice Snapshot**, the **Homepage template** (hero → proof → services → about → final CTA), the **Services Page template** (six types), the **About Page template** (annotated), the **Contact/Booking template**, and the **Copy Review Checklist** (the one test + 12 line-level checks). Fill them with your real positioning. The structure is the gift; the words have to be yours.



KEEP GOING

This is the copy companion to **The Build** — my full-site strategy and production service. If you'd rather hand the whole site to a team that does this daily, that's the service.

If the *positioning* underneath the copy still feels blurry, run the free **Positioning Checklist** first — it diagnoses the leaks before you write. And if your brand *voice* keeps going generic, **The Brand Voice Playbook** is the system that fixes it. Both at mkparrish.com.

A website doesn't need more words. It needs the right ones, in the right order, pointed at one action. Now you have them.

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NOTES

